Aubrey Freitas

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Education

Ph.D. Oregon State University, Clinical Psychology — Anticipated June 2031

M.S. Oregon State University, Psychology — Anticipated June 2027

B.A. University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA) — June 2019
Dual B.A.s in Psychology and English Literature
Concentration: Creative Writing - Fiction

Honors and Awards

Lenore Bayley Graduate Scholarship - Oregon State University
2026
Awarded on the basis of academic merit and promise for the future

Tarzana Treatment Centers and Colleges Full Academic Scholarship 2023
For individuals obtaining substance use disorder (SUD) counseling certification dedicated to serving the community

California Mental Health Services Authority (CalMHSA) Full Academic Scholarship 2023
For individuals obtaining Peer Support Specialist certification dedicated to working in the field of mental health

Mental Health America of Los Angeles Fellowship 2023

Most Likely To Brighten Your Day Award, UCLA 2019
Organization-level award given to a member of the Healthy Campus Initiative (HCI) who has positively impacted peers

Westwind Journal of the Arts Fiction Publication 2019

Dean's List Honors Scholar, UCLA 2018-2019

David Sedaris Humor Writing Award, UCLA Center for the Art of Performance 2018
Recognizing humor and wit in UCLA student writing

Publications

Freitas A. M., Chavez J. G., Chinchilla M., Calderon R., Chassman S., Hoffmann L., & Young A. S. (in press). Assessing the Acceptability and Feasibility of Wearable Mobile-Monitoring Devices Among Individuals with Serious Mental Illness: A Qualitative Study. *Journal of Medical Internet Research.*

Roggenkamp, H., **Freitas, A. M**., & Yarns, B. C. (in press). Teaching ISTDP to Complete Novice Therapists. *Journal of Contemporary ISTDP*.

Freitas, A.M., Liang, L.J., Chavez, J.G., Calderon, R., Hoffmann, L., & Young, A.S. (2025). Assessing the acceptability of weekly phone outreach and its impact on social connection and symptom monitoring among individuals with serious mental illness. *Human Factors in Healthcare*, 8, 100111. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.hfh.2025.100111.

Yarns, B.C., & **Freitas, A.M**. (2025). New Hope for Older Adults With Medical and Psychiatric Comorbidities. *Psychiatric Times*, 42(9). https://www.psychiatrictimes.com/view/new-hope-for-older-adults-with-medical-and-psychiatric-comorbidities.

Manuscripts In Preparation

Freitas, A. M., Yarns, B. C. (in preparation) Let the Anger Do What It Do -- and then Release: A Qualitative Study Comparing the Experiences of Older Adult Veterans with Chronic Pain in EAET vs. CBT.

Presentations and Invited Talks

Yarns, B. C., & **Freitas, A. M.** When the Body Speaks: Emotional Awareness and Expression Therapy for Chronic Pain. (2027, October). Invited talk for the 12th biennial meeting of the International Experiential Dynamic Therapy Association, Dubrovnik, Croatia.

Young, A. S., & **Freitas, A. M.** Symposium on the use of wearable devices in schizophrenia research. (2026, March). Invited talk at the 13th annual meeting of the Schizophrenia International Research Society, Florence, Italy.

Poster Presentations

Goldblum, R. S., Whittaker, F., **Freitas, A. M**., Perez, M., Morning, M., Gandhok, P., & Bradford, D. E. Shots and shocks: *A multiverse exploration of sex differences in alcohol's stress dampening effects*. (2026, Spring). Poster to be presented at the annual Society of Biological Psychiatry meeting, New York, NY.

Freitas, A.M., Cummings, C., Clair, K., & Gabrielian, S. (2025, August). *Acute care use among Veterans housed in HUD-VASH with co-occurring PTSD and SUD*. American Psychological Association 2025 Meeting, Denver, CO.

Research Experience

Graduate Research Assistant September 2025 - Present
Biology and Emotion of Addiction Via Experimental and Reproducible Science (BEAVERS) Lab
Oregon State University

Supervisor: Daniel Bradford, Ph.D.

- Safely and rigorously prepare and attach electromyography (EMG) and electroencephalography (EEG) psychophysiological sensors (Brain Products actiCHamp plus EEG-amplifiers system) for experimental task data collection for ongoing lab studies
- Implement computer-based experimental tasks using Psychophysiological Toolbox in MATLAB and BrainVision Recorder
- Facilitate the training of undergraduate lab members in psychophysiological measurement and data collection protocols
- Mentor undergraduate lab members on their independent research projects and future research goals

Graduate Research Assistant September 2025 - Present
Ascend Lab
Oregon State University
Supervisor: Kathryn Becker Blease, Ph.D.

- Conduct research examining the psychological impacts of trauma exposure using survey-based methodologies
- Assist with the development and refinement of measurement scales assessing trauma exposure and related psychological constructs
- Recruit and screen participants for trauma-focused research studies while maintaining confidentiality and participant safety
- Create surveys via Qualtrics, administer online and in-person assessments, and manage data collection processes

Research Coordinator, Project Manager January 2024 - Present
West Los Angeles Department of Veterans Affairs (VA)
Geriatric Research, Education, and Clinical Center (GRECC)
Supervisor: Brandon Yarns, M.D

- Coordinate a multi-site clinical trial examining the effects of virtual, group-based mindfulness, CBT, and emotional awareness and expression therapy (EAET) on pain symptom reduction for older adult veterans with chronic pain
- Design data collection instruments through building survey assessments in RedCap
- Utilize R and Excel programming tools to perform data validation
- Coach older adult veterans on using telehealth software
- Recruit study participants, performed phone screenings, and audited hours of therapy
- Train research coordinators in recruitment, study protocols, and data collection

Research Coordinator, Qualitative Interviewer October 2024 - July 2025
West Los Angeles Department of Veterans Affairs (VA)

National VA Virtual Care Consortium of Research (VCCR)
Supervisor: Alexander Young, M.D.

- Served as lead qualitative interviewer on a nationwide VA project exploring how patient-generated health data (PGHD) can be utilized, implemented, and improved to inform health care treatment
- Collaborated with VA team members across the nation to design mixed-methods data collection tools
- Analyzed data using rapid qualitative analysis

Project Manager October 2024 - July 2025
West Los Angeles Department of Veterans Affairs (VA)
Mental Illness Research, Education, and Clinical Centers (MIRECC)
Supervisor: Camilla Cummings, Ph.D.

- Spearheaded recruitment efforts for projects exploring 1) housing and health needs of homeless-experienced Veterans upon transitioning into permanent supportive housing (PSH) at the GLA VA and 2) analyzing PTSD and SUD comorbidities among homeless-experienced women Veterans within VA housing programs
- Created semi-structured interview guides for individual sessions and focus groups
- Coded and analyzed mixed methods data
- Co-authored a manuscript reporting research findings

Research Coordinator, Project Manager January 2024 - July 2025
West Los Angeles Department of Veterans Affairs (VA)
Mental Illness Research, Education, and Clinical Center (MIRECC)
Supervisor: Alexander Young, M.D.

- Led qualitative research and conducted semi-structured interviews with veterans with serious mental illness (SMI), utilizing mobile sensing health data collection to explore its potential benefits on treatment outcomes.
- First-authored two research manuscripts to disseminate findings, and contributed to grant proposal writing
- Analyzed mixed methods data, created a codebook within Atlas.ti, coded interview transcripts to evaluate findings
- Recruited participants, conducted baseline assessments utilizing the Brief Psychiatric Rating Scale (BPRS), and facilitated weekly data collection
- Managed IRB adherence

Undergraduate Research Assistant October 2016 - June 2019
UCLA Depression Grand Challenge
University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)
Supervisors: Elizabeth Gong-Guy, Ph.D., Allison Pimentel, Psy.D.

- Facilitated weekly support groups for UCLA students with mild to moderate depression and anxiety by utilizing an internet-based cognitive behavioral therapy (iCBT) program to explore its impacts on symptom reduction
- Collected qualitative data by conducting weekly semi-structured interviews surrounding student experiences with iCBT and facilitated quantitative data collection by administering check-in surveys
- Trained new research assistants on the cornerstones of CBT and support group facilitation

Volunteer Clinical Experience

988 Suicide Prevention and Crisis Lifeline - Didi Hirsch March 2023 - Present

Crisis Counselor

- Supported individuals experiencing suicidal ideation and those in extreme psychological or emotional pain
- Assessed for immediate safety and suicidal risk using various screening tools
- Practiced validation, reflective statements, and open-ended questions throughout calls
- Utilized high levels of empathy, emotional regulation, and presence

Professional Clinical Experience

Clare / Matrix Recovery Center October 2023 - August 2025

Registered Substance Use Disorder (SUD) Counselor

- Counseled individuals ages eighteen and over during the first one to three months of sobriety in the inpatient Women's Treatment Program (WTP) as a registered SUD counselor with the California Association of DUI Treatment Programs (CADTP).
- Led weekly individual and group counseling sessions
- Facilitated medication distribution for medication-assisted treatment (MAT)
- Crafted individualized recovery treatment plans and assisted with housing navigation and linkage to community resources

The People Concern July 2023 - January 2024

Case Manager

- Provided case management and housing navigation services in the Intensive Case Management (ICMS) program in Permanent Supportive Housing, working with homeless-experienced individuals.
- Supported various populations of homeless-experienced individuals, including those with mental illness, SUDs, and veterans
- Advocated for clients' housing rights, attainment, and maintenance
- Navigated crisis intervention and utilized trauma-informed care approaches

Mental Health America of Los Angeles (MHALA) April 2023 - July 2023
Jump Start Fellow

- This fellowship combines classroom education and practicum, allowing fellows to learn and work within the field of case management. I interned with a Full Service Partnership (FSP), Transition Age Youth (TAY) program designed for individuals hospitalized due to SMI.
- Conducted individual and group counseling sessions, coordinated community integration activities, and assessed barriers to quality of life
- Utilized non-violent communication, harm-reduction practices, and strengths-based approaches

Center For Autism and Related Disorders February 2020 - March 2021
Registered Behavioral Therapist

- Facilitated therapy sessions using Applied Behavioral Analysis (ABA) to help improve the cognitive, social, and motor functions of children on the Autism spectrum under the guidance of a board-certified behavioral analyst.
- Ensured accuracy of naturalistic data collection to track behavior changes and collaborated with treatment teams to create new therapeutic programs
- Built rapport with families and trained guardians on how to facilitate therapy programming

UCLA's Healthy Campus Initiative (HCI) - MindWell Pod May 2016 - June 2019
MindWell Blogger

- Wrote articles surrounding mental health, collaborated with professors, and acted as a wellness think tank to address student concerns surrounding well-being.
- Collected qualitative and quantitative data on student reactions to mental health pop-up events, presented findings to leadership, and secured funding for future events for students

Teaching and Mentorship

Instructor of Record, Department of Psychology April 2026 - Present
PSY 202Z - Introduction to Psychology
Oregon State University, Corvallis, OR

- Generate and lead lectures for up to 30 students
- Design lesson plans, learning materials, assignments, etc. based on desired student learning outcomes and program requirements
- Assess student work through grading assignments

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Psychology September 2026 - Present

PSY 201Z and PSY 202Z - Introduction to Psychology
Oregon State University, Corvallis, OR

- Assessed student work through grading weekly assignments and provided constructive feedback to enhance student learning
- Created study guides, exam materials, and facilitated review sessions for 50 undergraduate students
- Presented as a guest lecturer to classes with 200+ students and supported all teaching activities

Undergraduate Mentorship January 2026 - Present
Undergraduate Research Scholarships and the Arts (URSA) Engage Program
Oregon State University

- Mentoring first and second-year undergraduate and transfer students as they gain access to what is often their first hands-on research experience
- Training URSA lab members on collecting data using psychophysiological measurement, research design, and disseminating research findings
- Supporting URSA lab members in independent research projects and presentations surrounding their engagement in the BEAVERS lab

WriteGirl Mentor January 2022 - August 2025
Creative writing non-profit organization for girls and gender-expansive youth
Los Angeles, CA

- Facilitated weekly, one-on-one writing sessions with mentees passionate about fiction writing
- Guided mentees in developing core writing skills, creating individualized writing practices, and throughout the editing and revision processes
- Collaborated with program staff to host large-scale group writing workshops to enhance connection among mentees and provide diverse writing experiences

Involvement and Service

Eudaimonia Award Committee Member - UCLA 2022 - Present
UCLA's HCI MindWell Pod Assistant 2022 - 2025
Counselor/Cal. Association of DUI Treatment Programs 2023 - 2025
Tarzana Treatment Centers and Colleges SUD Counseling Program Graduate 2023 - 2024
Mental Health America of Los Angeles (MHALA) Jumpstart Fellowship Graduate 2023
Cal Mental Health Services Authority Peer Support Specialist Program Graduate 2023
Be Well Bruin App/Website Consultant and Contributor - UCLA 2022-2023

Bruin Mental Health Advisory Committee (BMHAC) - UCLA 2017 - 2019

Additional Training

Brief Psychiatric Rating Scale (BPRS)	2024
Disaster Crisis Counseling Certification	2024
Psychological First Aid Certification	2024
Mental Health Recovery Specialist Certification	2023
Mental Health First Aid - Youth and Adult Certification	2023
40 Hour Domestic Violence Counselor Training - The People Concern 2023	
Question, Persuade, Refer (QPR) Suicide Prevention Certification	2023
American Society of Addiction Medicine (ASAM) Certification	2023